Name it exactly

Name the feeling, find the word.
Say it so it's heard.

draft rhyme



I find the exact word for what I feel. Not just bad. Annoyed? Embarrassed? Let down? Sometimes it's two at once.

EXACT

Try it tonight

Think of one small thing that bugged you this week. Say the first word that comes. Probably bad, or mad. Now find a sharper word. Annoyed? Embarrassed? Left out? Let down? Jealous? Nervous? Pick one. If two fit, say both. Say it out loud: 'I felt embarrassed, and a bit annoyed.' Now give it a number from 1 to 10. That's it. The word is a tool, not a grade.

Scientists noticed that teens who name feelings exactly handle hard days a bit better. Nobody has tested teaching it yet.

Where it came from

In 2018, scientists at Harvard asked 143 people, from age 5 to age 25, how some pictures made them feel. Little kids and grown-ups used clear, separate feeling words. Teens tended to lump their feelings together. Another team in New York followed 233 teens for a year and a half: teens who could name feelings exactly were knocked down less by hard times.

Search:
emotion differentiation teens Nook Somerville

Backup: Long breath out

When I notice _____, I _____.

Pip's moves, chapter 4

Tomorrow: did you try it? did it help?